

Hound (*Quake II*)

5 This was debatably the most irritating character in the *Quake* series. It hides in the dark and does some chameleon-like tongue flicking action from 15 feet away... And it doesn't die easy. The next time you see this beast, use the rocket launcher or the rail gun. At least that's what we did!



Hand (*Blood*)

6 You're doing your bit—exorcised the demons, used TNT liberally, and basically creating hell. Suddenly you notice this hand scampering towards you. Before you have time to react, it jumps at you and grips your throat. Suddenly your screen goes black as you choke in its vice like grip. Fortunately, you can shake the creature off by repeatedly pressing the spacebar, but by the time you've managed to do that amidst all the fighting, you're dead! Very, very irritating!



Shodan (*System Shock*)

7 "Look at you, Hacker. A pathetic creature of meat and bone, panting and sweating as you run through my corridors. How can you challenge a perfect, immortal machine?" Shodan was an AI construct that you create in *System Shock*, made to oversee and manage a space station. She suddenly becomes a maniac, killing everyone onboard and converting some into cyborgs. While she never actually fights with you, Shodan controls the cyborgs and the whole spaceship, which you explore. There's always a lingering sense of her watching your every move, closing in on you through all her creatures. What builds your paranoia is that she actually has a personality—strong, malicious and intelligent, she hates the fact that her creator is human.



Howler (*Clive Baker's Undying*)

8 This has got to be the only monster whose absence scares you! They move in groups, bite your head off and eat it. To add to that, they howl. A lot. In fact, you hear them long before you even come across them. They're not too tough, but they move fast and attack in packs, often from different directions and at the same time. After your first encounter, every howl will make you look around frantically—with the biggest gun you've got.



Beheaded Kamikaze (*Serious Sam*)

9 These are amongst the most fun monsters in the entire FPS genre, and hear them long before you can see them. These headless zombies apparently had a prolific career as Al Qaeda suicide bombers. With two bombs in their hands, these monsters simply run into you and then blow you up. While they're easy to ward off, a dozen of them coming straight at you from all sides might be slightly more than you can handle.



Octabrain (*Duke Nukem 3D*)

10 One of the weirdest monsters in the *Duke Nukem* world, these octopus-like aliens use their psi energy to attack you. While they're easy to kill when far off, up close and personal combat requires you to dodge their psi-attacks. Get hit by one of these, and your screen blanks out for a moment. And it gets worse when they get their friends along. As the story goes, these aliens might also be responsible for all the cocooned damsels. And that makes Duke angry!

